box. Throughout this whole process, you would not find one person with any connection to a field or orchard.

And the final insight that really hit home for me that America was a land of processors, a country run by regulations and standards, was related to the fact that in New York, San Francisco, and everywhere in between, the electric socket was exactly the same! I had been used to Europe, with its jungle of electrical outlets.

In January 1985, it was decided with then-director of the Mossad Nahum Admoni that that summer I would go to the United States to study for one year and that the following summer I would be appointed as head of the Headquarters Division, a role that was considered, for all intents and purposes, to be that of deputy. This arrangement was a godsend for me from every perspective.

First of all, my formal appointment, a year and a half in advance, as the Mossad's number two man was no small matter. Likewise, a year of study at an American university was an opportunity for me to deepen my acquaintance with the United States and understand how this superpower thought, made decisions, and planned and implemented policy. In other words, this year was supposed to prepare me for being the future director of the Mossad.

I greatly appreciated the willingness of the "people of Israel" to fund a year of study for me in the United States, and I saw it as my duty to make the most of this year. I chose the best—Harvard University in Cambridge, Massachusetts. The application process was long and exhausting—interviews, tests, essay writing, and so on. For obvious reasons, throughout the entire acceptance process I had to find the right balance between what to reveal and what to hide. Only one person, the dean of Harvard Kennedy School of Government, had to be let in on the fact that I belonged to the Mossad.

Into that one calendar year I crammed two academic years. The curriculum I built converged, to the extent possible within the existing constraints, everything that could have contributed to a better and deeper understanding of what made America a world power. Through lectures, seminars, independent study, position papers, presentations, and tests, I studied topics including international relations and public policy; US foreign policy; how federal policy works; lessons from historical events as input into decision-making; American media and society; the battle among powers for